

Using the Dev Shop Starter Project

Before the next lesson, make sure the Dev Shop starter project is on your computer and running locally.

- Key concept:**Use the starter project files for the lessons.** The complete project files are there as a reference if you want to compare your work later.

Step 1: Download the project files

Open the **Course Files** tab for this course and download:

Starter Projects – Codex Workflows

- Use this to follow the course exercises.

Complete Projects – Codex Workflows

- Use this only as a reference

After downloading the starter ZIP, unzip it on your computer.

Step 2: Open the Shopping Cart project

For the next lesson, open this folder in Visual Studio Code:

 Starter Projects - Codex Workflows

 Dev Shop

 react_project ← open **this** folder

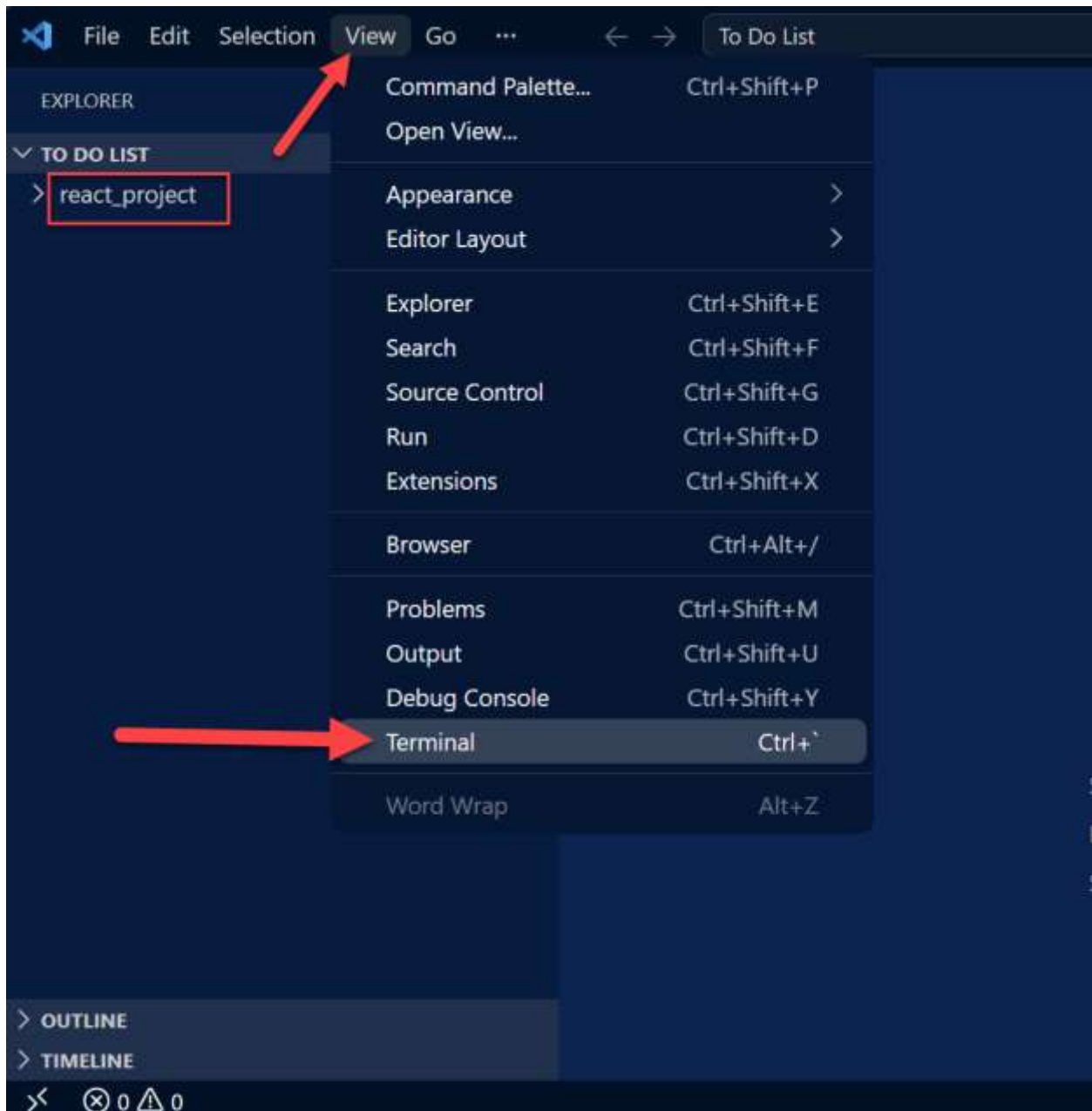
Make sure you open the react_project folder itself. This is the folder that contains package.json.

- Note:**What is package.json?** It is a small settings file for the project. It tells Node.js which tools the app needs and which commands you can run, such as npm run dev.

Step 3: Run the app locally

- Key concept:**Node.js note.** Node.js is needed to run these React project files locally.

Open the VS Code terminal while you are inside the react_project folder:



Then run npm like so:

```
npm install
```

```
npm run dev
```

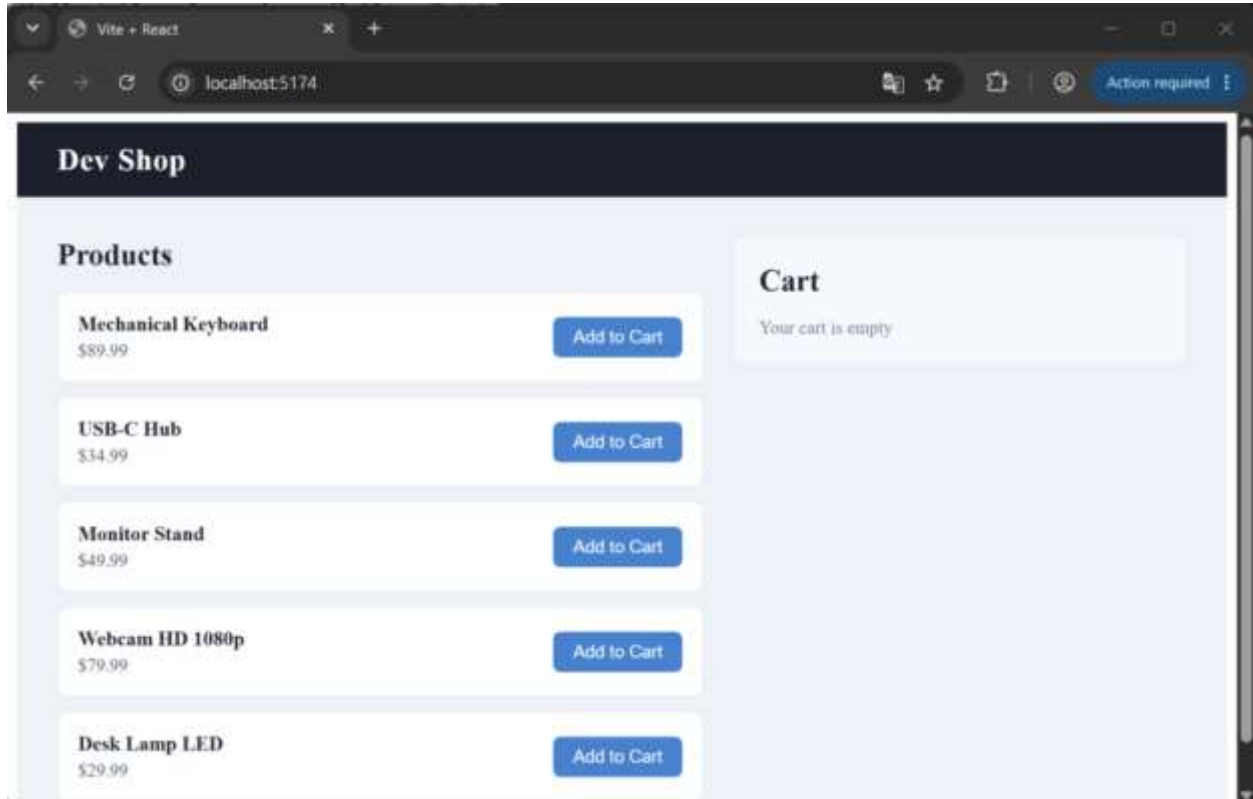
- **Note:What is npm?** npm is the tool that downloads the project tools listed in package.json and runs commands for the app. npm is included in the official Node.js installer.

The terminal will show a local URL, usually:

http://localhost:5173

Open that URL in your browser. Keep the terminal running while you work on the app.

You should see the Dev Shop in your browser.



Step 4: Start Codex in the same folder

In the project terminal, start Codex:

```
codex
```

Codex should start inside the same react_project folder. This helps Codex see the files, docs, tests, and AGENTS.md for that specific app.

Step 5: Run the tests when the course asks you to verify work

These projects include tests. When you need to check whether the project still works, run:

```
npm run test
```

If you make changes with Codex, run the tests again before moving on.

If something does not work

- Do:

- If npm is not found, install Node.js from <https://nodejs.org/download> and try again.
- If npm install fails, check that your terminal is inside the Shopping Cart App/react_project folder.
- If the browser does not show the app, use the exact local URL printed in your terminal.
- If Codex cannot find the files, start Codex from the same react_project folder.

Lessons